

LINTEL NY · LEAD MAGNET

NYC Co-op Renovation Checklist

23 Items for a Complete First-Submission Alteration Package

lintelny.com · (212) 347-2111 · info@lintelny.com

How to Use This Checklist

Most co-op alteration submissions get rejected on the first attempt — not because of the renovation itself, but because the submission package is incomplete. A complete first submission typically results in approval within 15–25 business days. An incomplete submission adds 30–60 days to your start date.

This checklist covers every document category required by NYC co-op alteration agreements. Every building is different — read your specific alteration agreement before finalizing your package. Items marked ORANGE are universally required. Items marked BLUE are building-specific.

ORANGE Universally required in all NYC co-op alteration agreements

BLUE Building-specific — required by many but not all buildings. Check your alteration agreement.

BLACK

Permit-related — required for all work involving DOB filings

SECTION A — Contractor Documents**1****REQUIRED****NYC HIC License Certificate**Copy of active NYC Home Improvement Contractor license. Verify at nyc.gov/dcwp. Must not be expired.**2****REQUIRED****General Liability Insurance Certificate (ACORD)**

Minimum \$1M per occurrence / \$2M aggregate. Building corporation named as Additional Insured. Certificate Holder = building address.

3**REQUIRED****Workers' Compensation Certificate or CE-200 Exemption**For sole proprietors with no employees: NYS CE-200 exemption from wcb.ny.gov. ACORD form alone is not accepted by most buildings.**4****REQUIRED****Contractor's License for Each Trade**

Licensed master plumber certificate for all plumbing. Licensed master electrician for all electrical. Each sub-trade must be separately licensed.

5**BUILDING****Additional Insured Endorsement Page**

Some buildings require a full endorsement page — not just the ACORD certificate — confirming the building as Additional Insured. Check your alteration agreement.

6

BUILDING**Certificate of Insurance for Each Subcontractor**

Many buildings require each subcontractor (plumber, electrician, tile setter) to carry their own GL and provide a certificate naming the building.

SECTION B — Scope of Work & Plans

7

REQUIRED**Written Scope of Work**

Detailed description of all work to be performed, by trade. Must reference existing and new conditions. Vague descriptions ('bathroom renovation') are routinely rejected.

8

REQUIRED**Floor Plan — Existing Conditions**

Accurate plan of the space as it currently exists, including walls, plumbing fixtures, electrical panel location, and any structural elements.

9

REQUIRED**Floor Plan — Proposed Conditions**

Proposed plan showing all changes. Must indicate any layout changes, new fixture locations, and plumbing/electrical rough-in paths.

1
0**BUILDING****Architect or Engineer Stamp**

Many buildings require plans to be stamped by a licensed architect or PE before submission — even for ALT2 work that does not legally require one for DOB filing.

1
1**BUILDING****MEP (Mechanical, Electrical, Plumbing) Drawings**

Buildings with complex rules or older infrastructure often require formal MEP drawings showing pipe routes, conduit paths, and HVAC connections.

1
2**BUILDING****Structural Engineer Sign-Off**

Required by most buildings for any work that touches structural elements — bearing walls, beams, columns, or floor joists.

SECTION C — DOB Permits & Filings

1
3

PERMIT

DOB Work Permit Application (ALT2)

Most kitchen and bathroom renovations that involve MEP work require an ALT2 filing with NYC DOB. File before work begins — never after.

1
4

PERMIT

Plumbing Permit (Sub-permit under ALT2)

All plumbing work in NYC requires a separate plumbing sub-permit filed by a licensed master plumber. The master plumber files this directly with DOB.

1
5

PERMIT

Electrical Permit (Sub-permit under ALT2)

All electrical work in NYC requires an electrical sub-permit. Filed by a licensed master electrician. Includes panel work, GFCI circuits, and new outlets.

1
6

BUILDING

Building Department Approval Letter

Some buildings require a formal approval letter from the managing agent or board before DOB permits can be filed. Confirm sequence with your managing agent.

SECTION D — Building Logistics & Compliance

1
7

REQUIRED

Alteration Agreement — Signed and Notarized

The agreement between you (the shareholder) and the co-op corporation. Must be signed and often notarized before any contractor can begin work.

1
8**REQUIRED****Alteration Deposit — Check to Managing Agent**

Typically \$1,000–\$5,000 refundable deposit held during construction. Confirm exact amount and payee in your alteration agreement.

1
9**BUILDING****Neighbor Notification Letters**

Most buildings require written notice to adjacent apartments (above, below, left, right) a minimum of 5–14 days before work begins.

2
0**BUILDING****Work Hours Confirmation**

Most NYC co-ops restrict work to weekdays 8am–5pm. Some allow Saturday 9am–4pm. Confirm hours and include them in your contractor's schedule.

2
1**BUILDING****Elevator Booking / Protection Deposit**

Buildings typically require advance booking of service elevator and a deposit for elevator protection (padded blankets). Coordinate with super.

2
2**BUILDING****Superintendent Pre-Work Inspection**

Many buildings require the superintendent to inspect the space before work begins and sign a pre-work condition report protecting both parties.

2
3**BUILDING****Final Superintendent Sign-Off**

After work completes, the superintendent inspects the finished space, confirms all building rules were followed, and releases the alteration deposit.

Typical Timeline from Contract Signing to Work Start

Complete first submission → Board approval: 15–25 business days (if the board meets monthly, add 2–4 weeks if you miss the cycle). DOB permit (filed in parallel): 5–15 business days. Total time from contract signing to work start for a well-prepared package: 4–8 weeks. For a package submitted incomplete: 8–16 weeks or longer.

About Lintel NY

Lintel NY is a licensed NYC Home Improvement Contractor (HIC #2109847-DCA) serving all five boroughs and Long Island. We read every alteration agreement before pricing any co-op project. Our complete first-submission packages have a strong approval track record. Contact us for a free consultation: (212) 347-2111 · info@lintelny.com · lintelny.com